



The Charter Says You Decide

Surveying Shared-Office Occupants Against Six Months of Central Override Logs

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The problem

The Shared Comfort Charter grants every shared-office zone a local setpoint and a documented right to adjust it. Facilities' central energy panel retains an override it exercises without notification. How much thermostat authority do occupants believe they hold, and how much does the panel's own log record them holding?

Research questions

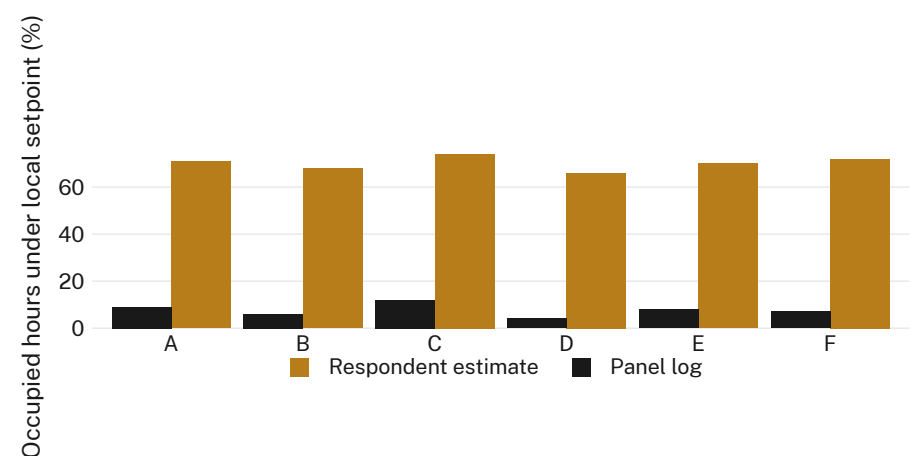
- What share of occupied hours do occupants estimate their local setpoint governs?
- What share does the central panel's log record it governing?
- Does the Charter's language track either quantity?

Study design

- 186 staff · 6 shared-office zones · self-administered instrument · one survey window
- Panel export: six months of override events, zone-matched, occupied hours only
- Charter clause-by-clause coding against the two quantities; no zone excluded

What we found

Respondent estimates cluster tightly and high. The panel's log, covering the same zones over the same period, records local setpoint authority an order of magnitude lower. The Charter's control language is invariant across zones and tracks neither series.



Across all six zones respondents estimated local setpoint authority at 66–74% of occupied hours; the central panel's own logs record it at 4–12%. No zone's estimate fell within 50 percentage points of its logged value, and no respondent reported having been notified of an override.

Interpretation

Perceived thermostat authority appears to be sustained by the Charter's wording rather than by the panel's behaviour. The override is not concealed; it is simply never surfaced to the zone it acts on, and the instrument that documents the right is silent on the mechanism that supersedes it.

A conferred entitlement may persist unqualified in occupant belief while remaining unexercised in practice. Next: an audit of what the Charter's next revision cycle does with the log.

Selected references

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Survey responses de-identified at collection; zone labels randomised on export. Panel logs obtained under standing internal access. No setpoint was altered for the purposes of this study.

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